

TIMELINE

- **March 22, 1817** Born, the son of a carpenter, in Warrenton, North Carolina.
- **1837** Graduates from West Point Military Academy fifth in his class and is commissioned a second lieutenant in the artillery.
- **1846-48** Serves under General Zachary Taylor in the War with Mexico.
- **1855** Resigns from the army and buys a sugar plantation at Thibodaux in Louisiana. Enslaves more than 100 people.
- **March 7, 1861** As Civil War approaches, Bragg is made a brigadier general in the Confederate army; he is sent to Pensacola, Florida, where he is promoted to major general on September 12.
- **April 6-7, 1862** Serving under General Albert Johnston, Bragg takes part in the battle of Shiloh and is promoted to full general as a reward for his aggressive performance.
- **June 1862** Appointed commander of the Army of Mississippi.
- **August-October 1862** Bragg's invasion of Kentucky fails, damaging his reputation.
- **November 20, 1862** Bragg is put in command of the newly formed Army of Tennessee.
- **December 31, 1862-January 2, 1863** At the Battle of Stones River, Bragg makes the decision to withdraw after three days' fighting; heavily criticized, he nonetheless retains his post.
- **September 19-20, 1863** Wins a costly victory at Chickamauga but is again blamed for an allegedly dilatory pursuit to Chattanooga.
- **November 29, 1863** After defeats at Lookout Mountain (November 24) and Missionary Ridge (November 25), Bragg asks to be relieved of command of the Army of Tennessee.
- **February 1864** Appointed military adviser to President Davis, an essentially administrative role.
- **January 15, 1865** As commander of the Department of North Carolina, Bragg is charged with responsibility for the loss of Fort Fisher.
- **March 19-21, 1865** Returns to combat as a subordinate commander in the defeat at Bentonville, the last battle in the Western Theater.
- **1865-74** Earns a living through various civilian jobs, including chief engineer of the Gulf, Colorado, and Santa Fe railroad.
- **September 27, 1876** Dies suddenly while walking down a street in Galveston, Texas.